



Visa Tap to Phone Framework

V.5.2.1

Tap to Phone Supplemental Requirements



May 2025

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Revision Log

The following summarizes the changes to this framework since the publication of the Visa Tap to Phone Framework, version 3.6.1:

Version and Date	Description of Change
V.4. May 2023	- Added Revision Log section. - Added Terminal Type Classification Table. - Removed COTS reference in scope and linked definition of Qualifying Hardware for Visa Tap to Phone Program to Terminal Type Classification Table. - Clarified Functional L2 Testing requirements in table in Functional & Security requirements section. - Added Visa Ready solution with PCI MPoC solution security certification and its corresponding testing details as an option in the Application and SDK Approval and Testing section. - Removed Initial number of eligible participants in the Merchant Eligibility, Communications, and Training section. - Changed Contactless criteria to a recommendation for deployment and mentioned approval requirement for the United States of America in the Merchant Eligibility, Communications, and Training section. - Detailed Acquirer's responsibility to register Payment Facilitators as Third-Party Agents in the Merchant Eligibility, Communications, and Training section. - Clarified applicability of manual reporting only to deployments in countries with domestic processing where collections-only is not available in Transaction Configuration and Reporting Requirements section. - Merged Merchant Eligibility and Communications & Training into a new combined section. - Outlined legal agreement requirement(s) for Acquirers and Solution Provider in the Approval Process section. - Removed reference to initial number of merchants in the Scaling Tap to Phone Solutions section. - Removed reference to initial number of merchants in the <i>Scaling Tap to Phone Solutions</i> section.
V.4.1 July 2023	- Clarified permissible exception use cases on use of NFC antenna for Card Not Present (CNP) transactions. - Included "reader" in Qualifying hardware definition.
V.5.0 October 2023	- Updated wording for Consumer Choice Requirements in Europe. - Removed Launch Approval by Visa requirement from Functional and Security Requirements. - Redefined international spend threshold and requirement for merchants. - Removed callout on acquirer responsibility for merchant rules and standards as Tap to Phone specific. - Removed callout on acquirer responsibility for merchant support and training as Tap to Phone specific. - Updated merchant monthly reporting requirements to transaction coding requirements.

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	• Removed callout of Visa Easy Payment Service (VEPS) requirement as Tap to Phone specific. • Removed callout on acquirer responsibility to keep control on merchant portfolio as Tap to Phone specific. • Updated Acquirer's responsibility to ensure merchants incorporate the Visa Digital Brand Requirements. • Updated definition of Tap to Phone. • Redefined merchant eligibility criteria. • Updated reference to qualifying countries and territories for additional use-cases. • Added merchant eligibility for side-by-side use with RTPs, AltPays, and Closed Loop Wallets. • Clarified Unattended Cardholder-Activated Terminal (UCAT) as not allowed for General Availability. • Added clarification on permissible deployments in Transit. • Clarified compliance requirements for integrations of Visa Ready Full SDKs. • Removed reporting requirements. • Removed product enrollment tool requirement for acquirers. • Updated Approval Process.
V.5.1 September 2024	• Updated Terminal Type Classification characteristics. • Updated EMVCo Proximity Coupling Device (PCD) L1 read range testing requirements for Visa's Tap to Phone Terminal Types. • Clarified prohibited use cases, including using Tap to Phone solution to provision digital wallets.
V.5.2 April 2025	• Updated sunset of the Visa Tap to Phone Security Requirements and transition to PCI Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC) and PCI Contactless Payments on COTS (CPoC) accreditation. • Removed reference to Commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) in Introduction and Scope sections. • Moved Third-Party Agent (TPA) registration from Scope to Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer Responsibilities section. • Renamed Application and SDK Approval and Testing section to Solution Approval and Testing. • Renamed Merchant Eligibility, Communications, and Training section to Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer Responsibilities. • Updated Merchant Eligibility criteria to match April 2025 Visa Rules Contactless-only Acceptance Device update release. • Removed requirement for Acquirer to have a Tap to Phone License Agreement. • Updated L1 Requirement for Consumer Qualifying Hardware from required to recommended as of September 2027.
V.5.2.1 May	• Updated MPoC qualifying criteria including Visa Ready applicability, integration security requirements, and acquirer deployment applicability and responsibility.

Introduction

The Visa Tap to Phone program allows merchants to accept Visa contactless payments directly on their NFC-enabled mobile devices with no need for an additional connected device / dongle / hardware attachment.

Tap to Phone solutions aid device manufacturers, software developers, payment service providers, merchants, and acquirers in providing a reliable, convenient, and secure point-of-sale experience in a *Qualifying Hardware*. Deployment of these solutions is governed by global and regional Visa teams, via the operating framework detailed in this document, and conditional upon solutions being approved under the Visa Ready program.

This document outlines the operating framework for deploying Tap to Phone solutions.

Audience

This document is intended for acquirers, payment facilitators, payment service providers, and solution providers intending to participate in the Visa Tap to Phone program to develop, certify, and launch solutions for NFC-enabled Tap to Phone acceptance with no additional hardware.

Scope

This framework focuses on *Qualifying Hardware*, mobile acceptance client applications, and processing requirements for acquirers, payment facilitators, and solution providers that wish to participate in the Visa Tap to Phone program.

Refer to the [Terminal Type Classification](#) section in this document for details and conditions on *Qualifying Hardware*. A device that is primarily manufactured to accept payment transactions does not qualify as a *Qualifying Hardware*.

Related Publications

To facilitate market requirements while ensuring interoperability, where applicable, devices accepting Visa cards must adhere to and comply with the following related publications.

Table 1: Related Publications

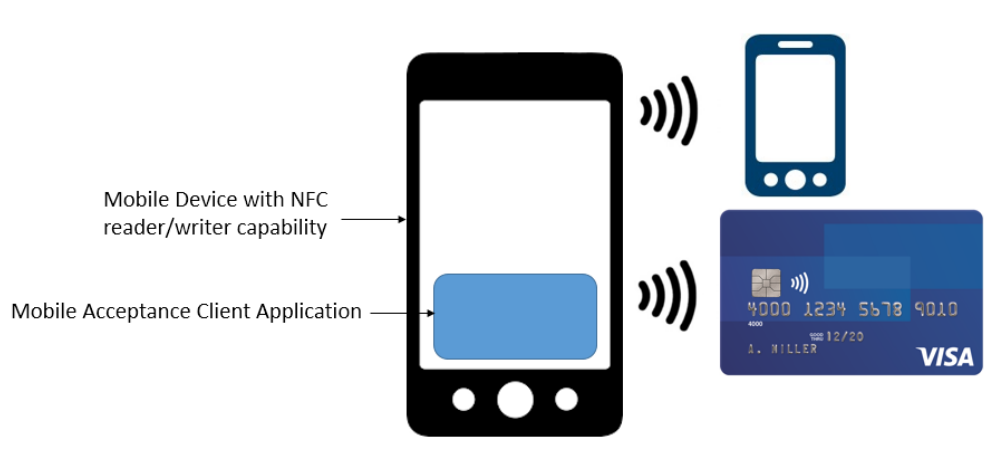
Title	How to Obtain
<i>Visa Core Rules and Visa Product and Service Rules</i>	Visa representative
<i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements</i>	Tap to Phone Visa Ready Program in Visa Partner and Visa Access for Visa members
<i>Visa Contactless Payment Specifications (VCPS)</i>	Tap to Phone Visa Ready Program in Visa Partner and Visa Access for Visa members
<i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Kernel Specification (VRTPKS)</i>	Tap to Phone Visa Ready Program in Visa Partner and Visa Access for Visa members
<i>Visa Tap to Phone Contactless Alternatives - UX Guide</i>	Tap to Phone Visa Ready Program in Visa Partner and Visa Access for Visa members
<i>Payment Card Industry Data Security Standards (PCI DSS)</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org
<i>PCI Mobile Payment Acceptance Security Guidelines for Vendors</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org
<i>PCI Secure Reading and Exchange of Data</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org
<i>PCI Contactless Payments on COTS (CPoC)</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org
<i>PCI Software-based PIN Entry on COTS (SPoC)</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org
<i>PCI Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC)</i>	http://www.pcisecuritystandards.org

1 Overview

Visa defines a Tap to Phone payment acceptance solution as a mobile acceptance client application that uses the NFC reader/writer capabilities present within a *Qualifying Hardware* to process Visa contactless payments (see Figure 1–1). These solutions do not require any external hardware (for example, a contactless dongle or Secure Card Reader) to facilitate contactless payments.

Mobile payment acceptance solutions process payments by connecting to an acquirer directly or through a Payment Facilitator; therefore, the *Qualifying Hardware* must be able to wirelessly communicate across open networks.

Figure 1–1: Components of Tap to Phone Solutions



1.1 Applicability

The conditions for the program are designed to drive net-new acceptance and improve the point-of-sale experience, whilst minimizing impact to cardholders.

Functional, Security Requirements, and Branding requirements as well as merchant eligibility criteria is described in the corresponding sections below in this document.

Note: The following implementations are NOT allowed:

- Using the NFC antenna to capture payment credentials to process transactions as e-commerce Card Not Present (CNP) transactions except for use cases highlighted in requirement 6 and 8 of Table 2.1 Functional and Security Requirements. All Tap to Phone transactions in which the NFC antenna is used must be processed as contactless Card Present (CP) transactions.

- Converting an e-commerce transaction flow (Card Not Present) into a Tap to Phone flow (Card Present) so that a buyer can complete an e-commerce transaction by tapping their own Visa contactless payment credential onto their own mobile device.
- Using a Tap to Phone solution to capture payment credentials to provision a digital wallet of any type (e.g., digital wallet solution for consumer-based proximity payments, issuer digital mobile wallet, or merchant-operated digital wallet) or a card-on-file.
- Using a Tap to Phone solution to process any other type of Visa transaction, including a Peer-to-Peer (P2P) transaction or any event other than an attended, Card Present (CP) payment transaction with a *Qualifying Hardware*.
- Enabling Tap to Phone as an unattended terminal.

1.2 Term

Visa reserves the right to terminate a solution deployment, amend operating conditions, or exclude specific merchants, in its sole discretion, by providing written notice to participants.

2 Operating Conditions

Operating conditions, parameters, and qualification criteria are outlined below.

2.1 Functional & Security Requirements

Table 2-1 provides the overarching functional and security requirements of the consumer mobile device and mobile acceptance client application submitted to the Visa Tap to Phone program. Detailed requirements can be accessed in the Tap to Phone Visa Ready Program in Visa Partner and Visa Access.

Table 2–1: Functional & Security Requirements

Item	Functional & Security Requirements
1.	Solutions must be approved through the Tap to Phone Visa Ready program as compliant to technical standards outlined in the <i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements</i> .
2.	Functional requirements: - L1 Testing: testing may be required for some device categories. Refer to the Terminal Type Classification Section. - L2 Functional Testing: solutions are required to use a Visa Ready Tap to Phone compliant Kernel to ensure compliance to the <i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Kernel Specification (VRTPKS)</i> and applicable <i>Visa Contactless Payment Specification (VCPS)</i> criteria. Refer to the <i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements</i> for details on available options for compliance.
3.	Security requirements: Solutions must undergo a security evaluation by a PCI-Recognized security laboratory in adherence to either: - PCI Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC) Security Requirements standard, or - PCI Contactless Payments on COTS (CPoC) Security Requirements standard. Review section 2.2 Solution Approval and Testing for details on MPoC qualifying criteria including Visa Ready applicability, integration security requirements, and acquirer deployment applicability and responsibility.
4.	Solutions must incorporate the Visa-owned suite of Visa sensory brand marks for physical retail point of sale locations, which is a combination of haptic, animation, and sound files, software development kits, and related technical documentation, all of which are provided to or made available to the Acquirer and Solution Provider by Visa ("Visa Sensory Brand Materials"). Access and use of the Visa Sensory Brand Materials are governed by the Branding Requirements.

Item	Functional & Security Requirements
	Compliance with the Branding Requirements is mandatory and a material condition to the launch of any Solution. If Acquirer and/or Solution Provider fail to otherwise implement Branding Requirements, Visa may withhold or rescind approval of the Solution. Tap to Phone Branding Requirements are included in Visa's Tap to Phone supplemental requirements.
5.	L3 Testing is required for all deployments. Scenarios where retesting is not required can be consulted in the <i>Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements</i> .
6.	Payment Link (Card Not Present) support is optional, as a method of allowing sellers to accept non-contactless-enabled cards when the buyer does not have a contactless payment credential. This option is only permitted as an alternate way of processing when a Tap to Phone contactless Card-Present transaction cannot be completed. Refer to <i>Visa Tap to Phone Contactless Alternatives - UX Guide</i> for use cases and best practice guidelines.
7.	The mobile acceptance client application must have the ability to be deactivated at a wholesale, or merchant-specific level.
8.	For transactions over the CVM limit in offline PIN markets: Canada, UK, Israel, France, and Ireland, participating sellers with Tap to Phone solutions are permitted to enable Payment Link Card-Not-Present transactions to cardholders for transactions that would otherwise be unable to successfully conclude as a standard contactless card present transaction solely because the amount of the transaction exceeds the cardholder verification limit of the card being used. The transaction may be only used as an alternative and not as the primary method of capturing contactless transactions under the cardholder verification limit. Refer to <i>Visa Tap to Phone Contactless Alternatives - UX Guide</i> for use cases and best practice guidelines.
9.	Tap to Phone solutions that operate in the European Union, UK (and Gibraltar, where relevant) need to adhere to <i>Visa's Consumer Choice Requirements</i> as detailed in the Visa Rules and Strong Consumer Authentication (SCA) regulations where applicable. The Visa Rules mirror the Interchange Fee Regulations (IFR) requirement that consumers must be allowed to determine the final selection of payment scheme for co-badged cards. Refer to <i>Consumer Choice in Europe, Best Practice Guide, Visa Core Rules, and Visa Product and Service Rule (23 April 2022)</i> and future versions available in Visa Access for further details on the requirements.

2.2 Solution Approval and Testing

All solutions require to comply with, Functional, Branding, and Security requirements to obtain a Visa Ready approval and to be able to process Visa Transactions. Acquirers and Solution Providers are responsible to ensure that all requirements are met.

Refer to Table 2-2 for details on MPoC qualifying criteria including Visa Ready applicability, integration security requirements, and acquirer deployment applicability and responsibility.

Table 2-2 MPoC Qualifying Criteria

MPoC Product¹	Variant	Visa Ready Tap to Phone Program Applicability	Tap to Phone Application Integration Security Requirements	Acquirer Deployment Applicability²	Acquirer Responsibility
MPoC Solution	Monolithic MPoC Solution	Yes	None (MPoC Solution – Monolithic listed)	Yes	Validate VR TTP Approval (MPoC Solution – Monolithic)
	Non-Mono MPoC Solution	Yes	None (MPoC Solution – Non-Monolithic listed)	Yes	Validate VR TTP Approval (MPoC Solution – Non-Monolithic)
MPoC Software	Isolated SDK (An SDK only, without an app)	Yes	N/A (Product does not contain an application)	No	N/A (Product does not contain an application)
	Non-Isolated SDK (An SDK only, without an app)	No	N/A (Product does not contain an application)	No	N/A (Product does not contain an application)
	MPoC Application (An app only)	Yes	None (MPoC Software – Application listed)	Yes	Validate VR TTP Approval (MPoC Software – Application)
	Composite MPoC Application (An app using an Isolated SDK)	No	Must perform Vendor Verification (via the SDK vendor/lab)	Yes	Validate: 1) VR TTP Approval (MPoC Software – Isolated SDK) 2) PCI listing (preferred) / Vendor Verification Integration Report ³
	Composite MPoC Application (An app using a Non-Isolated SDK)	No	Must achieve MPoC Solution – Non-Monolithic listing	No	Should inform vendor to achieve VR TTP Approval as MPoC Solution – Non-Monolithic Note: MPoC Software – Non-Isolated SDK is not an applicable VR TTP solution

The Tap to Phone Visa Ready program also allows PCI SSC listed CPoC Solutions to obtain a Visa Ready approval.

All approved Visa Ready Solutions need to maintain a valid PCI MPoC approval as detailed in Table 2-2, which includes successfully completing the Annual Checkpoints as required by PCI MPoC.

Upon expiry, all solutions previously certified to the *Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements* must be evaluated to applicable PCI Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC) Security Requirements and listed as one of the Visa Tap to Phone Program accepted accreditations as part of the new certifications.

A security approval to any of the above security requirements is not sufficient by itself to receive a Visa Ready approval. Compliance to Functional and Branding requirements is also mandatory. All deployments must be powered by an approved and valid Visa Ready solution.

¹ Must support COTS-native NFC interface

² L3 testing must be completed prior to deployment. Please refer to Visa Ready Tap to Phone Solution Requirements for more details.

³ Actual Vendor Verification can be performed by the vendor or the associated MPoC lab

2.3 Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer Responsibilities

Table 2-3 provides the eligibility criteria for participating Merchants and Acquirer responsibilities. All Acquirers and Merchants must continue to meet all applicable Visa Rules requirements.

Table 2-3: Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer responsibilities

Item	Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer responsibilities
1.	Tap to Phone solutions can be deployed to enable faster customer throughput ("queue-busting"). A Merchant may deploy a Contactless-only Acceptance Device if all Cards are accepted at other Acceptance Devices at the Merchant Outlet.
2.	For Merchants that do not exceed USD 1 million in annual Visa Transaction volume, a Merchant may deploy a Tap to Phone solution without additional Acceptance Devices being available at the Merchant Outlet, if International Transactions ⁴ do not exceed 10% of the Merchant's total annual Visa Transaction volume.
3.	For all other use cases, a Merchant may deploy a Tap to Phone solution if both: • International Transactions⁴ do not exceed 10% of the Merchant's total annual Visa Transaction volume. • All other Cards are accepted either: ○ At other Acceptance Devices at the Merchant Outlet. ○ On the Merchant's website or application.
4.	A Merchant may deploy a Tap to Phone Solution to be allowed side-by-side with merchants offering only Real-Time Payment (RTPs), Alternative Payments (AltPays), or other Closed-Loop Payment wallets and systems that did not previously offered Visa's acceptance.
5.	A Tap to Phone Solution must not be deployed as an Unattended Cardholder-Activated Terminal (UCAT).
6.	For Transit Tap to Phone deployments, fare inspection or casual sales are acceptable for merchants that have deployed Mass Transit Transaction (MTT). Tap to Phone is not allowed for place of boarding that requires high-speed throughput.

⁴ In the Europe Region: International Transactions, excluding European Economic Area (EEA) Transactions.

Item	Merchant Eligibility and Acquirer responsibilities
7.	Acquirers participating must ensure that there is visibility of the merchants being on-boarded (reported to Visa, upon request). If a Payment Facilitator is responsible for merchant on-boarding, they must work with the acquirer to provide the level of visibility. Program participants must adhere to Visa's Tap to Phone transaction coding. Acquirers must register Payment Facilitators in the Visa Third Party Agent Program as described in the Scope section of this document. A Third-Party Agent (TPA) registration into Visa of a Payment Service Provider, Payment Facilitatory, or any other is required when the provider stores, transmits, or processes Visa account data on behalf of a Visa client. Acquirers contracting with Payment Facilitators must obtain from Visa a unique Payment Facilitator identifier that must be assigned by the Acquirer to each Payment Facilitator to use in Transaction processing.
8.	Acquirers must ensure that participating Merchants incorporate the Visa Digital Brand Requirements in their solution.
9.	The contactless performance can vary from one device to another and the 'NFC sweet spot' will not always be the same on every device, due to the location of the antenna and possible interference of other devices, e.g., protective cases or battery-boosters. Merchants will have to test for the optimum "read" location on their own device, including whether to leave on or take off extra device paraphernalia. Acquirers should work directly with merchants or through the solution provider to help merchants become familiar with the contactless performance of their NFC enabled devices.
10.	Acquirers must comply to the responsibilities outlined in the MPoC Qualifying Criteria table as detailed in the Solution Approval and Testing section.

2.4 Transaction Configuration

Tap to Phone transactions must be configured with the following fields in the Base I/SMS Authorization and Base II (Clearing & Settlement) messages:

Base I/SMS (Authorization)	Base II (Clearing & Settlement)
Field 60.1 – Position 1, Terminal Type: 9: Mobile Acceptance Solution	Acceptance Terminal Indicator, TCR 1 – Additional Data, Position 124:9 = Mobile Acceptance Solution
Field 60.2 – Position 2, Terminal Entry Capability: 8: Contactless Proximity-Read-Capable Terminal	POS Terminal Capability, TCR 0 – Terminal Capability, Position 158: 8 = Proximity read capability Terminal

Field 55 supplemental – Form Factor Indicator (Tag 9F6E) is required to be sent if personalized on the card	TCR 7, Form Factor Indicator (Tag 9F6E) is required to be sent if this data object has been included in the Authorization message (in Field 55)
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3 Approval Process

- Solution providers (and Acquirers developing their own Visa Ready Solution) must register in the Tap to Phone program Visa Ready through in Visa Partner Portal: <https://partner.visa.com/>.
- Solution providers must have a valid Tap to Phone Solution Provider Agreement.
- All deployments must be powered by an approved and valid Visa Ready solution.
- Deployments of Tap to Phone solutions are only allowed by merchants compliant to the criteria laid out in the Visa Rules and outlined in the Merchant Eligibility table in this framework.

Solutions **must** be fully compliant with technical, security, and branding standards as established by Visa prior to launch.

4 Terminal Type Classification

The following table describes *Qualifying Hardware* for Tap to Phone:

Characteristics	1. Cell Phone (Consumer)	2. Tablet (Consumer)	3. Mobile Computer (Business)	4. Tablet (Business)
Primary purpose	Voice/video calls (communication)	Infotainment	Non-payment business operations	Non-payment business operations
Power source	Battery	Battery	Battery	Battery
NFC antenna	Native embedded	Native embedded	Native embedded	Native embedded
Data connection	Untethered (Wi-Fi / cellular)	Untethered (Wi-Fi / cellular)	Untethered (Wi-Fi / cellular)	Untethered (Wi-Fi / cellular)
Other purpose	Multipurpose (not primarily for payments)	Multipurpose (not primarily for payments)	Multipurpose (not primarily for payments)	Multipurpose (not primarily for payments)
Operating system	Commercially available OS (Android / iOS)	Commercially available OS (Android / iOS)	Commercially available OS (Android / iOS)	Commercially available OS (Android / iOS)
Magstripe & Contact Chip	None	None	None	None
Integration	Standalone (end-product)	Standalone (end-product)	Standalone (end-product)	Standalone (end-product)
Mobile / Fixed	Mobile	Mobile	Mobile	Mobile
Software distribution	Controlled by the device's native OS provider and/or device manufacturer	Controlled by the device's native OS provider and/or device manufacturer	MDM (Mobile Device Management) or Pre-installed	MDM (Mobile Device Management) or Pre-installed
Display size (diagonal)	Less than 7.6 inches	More than 7.6 inches	Less than 7.6 inches	More than 7.6 inches

The following table describes applicable testing for a Tap to Phone solution:

Category	Mobile Phone (Consumer)	Tablet (Consumer)	Mobile Computer (Business)	Tablet (Business)
Tap to Phone Stage	General Availability	General Availability	General Availability	General Availability
Environment	Attended	Attended	Attended	Attended
L1 Requirement	Consult table below	Consult table below	Consult table below	Consult table below
L2 Requirement	VRTPKS	VRTPKS	VRTPKS	VRTPKS
Branding Approval	TTP Branding Requirements	TTP Branding Requirements	TTP Branding Requirements	TTP Branding Requirements
Security Requirement	MPoC	MPoC	MPoC	MPoC
L3 Testing	Required	Required	Required	Required

EMVCo Proximity Coupling Device (PCD) L1 read range testing requirements for Visa's Tap to Phone Terminal Types:

Terminal Type	Before Sep 1, 2024	As of Sep 1, 2024	As of Sep 1, 2025	As of Sep 1, 2027
Mobile Phone (Consumer)	Not required	RR1 recommended	RR1 recommended	RR1 recommended
Tablet (Consumer)	Not required	RR2 recommended	RR2 recommended	RR2 recommended
Mobile Computer (Business)	Not required	RR2 recommended	RR2 required for new deployments	RR2 required for all deployments
Tablet (Business)	Not required	Full Range PCD recommended	Full Range PCD required for new deployments	Full Range PCD required for all deployments

